

Saving a clip

The basic cutting operation involves the use of the A and B markers on the bottom bar. There are a few options available for navigation through the timeline. The first set of arrows are for going forward or backward by a single frame. The second set, made up of double arrows like the fastforward icon are used for navigating to previous and next keyframes, which will be explained shortly. Then come the A and B markers, after which are forward and back arrows with a black bar. This is a time consuming and processor intensive way of finding the next or previous black frame, and we suggest that you never use it. It is always quicker to just find it yourself. The remaining arrow control options are irrelevant, and frankly, unnecessary. What you need to know for using Avidemux is that a video is made up of a series of frames, and most modern video formats store videos by using what are called keyframes. Keyframes are a reference frame, after which subsequent frames save only the pixels that have changed in comparison to the keyframe. This is an effective way to compress the video, as against saving all the information in every frame of a video file. Typically, there are between three two four keyframes in every second of video. Now, Avidemux allows you to cut a video and save it at any frame. However, if the cut does not start at a keyframe, then there is a problem as the video playback software does not have the reference frame in comparison to which the subsequent frames have changed. This can lead to weird artefacts at the start of the video. Now, it is also important to note that the A marker includes the frame it is marked on, while the B marker excludes the frame it is marked on. So a clip cut from a video can be represented as [A, B). Drag the slider roughly to the location where you want to make the first cut, then use the double forward arrow or the double backward arrow to find the nearest keyframe. Click on the B marker, and go to Edit > Cut. Now, go to the place where you want the video to end, and click on the A marker. As this is towards the end of the video, and the previous keyframe is always included no matter what, this cut point does not have to be on a keyframe. Click on File > Save.

Cut out a portion of a video

Deleting a portion of a video, or multiple segments involves placing an A and B marker on the areas that you want to remove, then clicking on Edit > Delete, or simply pressing the Delete key. Avidemux works quickly